Lorenzo Lorenzetti

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RESEARCH AREAS

AOS Philosophy of Science, Philosophy of Physics, Metaphysics

EMPLOYMENT

Postdoctoral Researcher 2024—
Institute of Philosophy, Università della Svizzera italiana (USI), Lugano

EDUCATION

PhD in Philosophy – University of Bristol 2021–2024

Supervisors: James Ladyman, Karim Thébault
Examiners: Nick Huggett, Samir Okasha
Thesis: 'Functional Reduction in the Physical Sciences'

MA in Philosophy – Università della Svizzera italiana (USI), Lugano 2019–2021

Supervisors: Christian Wüthrich, Tim Maudlin
Thesis: 'Functionalism, Reduction, Levels: Reconsidering the Ontology of Wave Function Realism'

BA in Philosophy – Vita-Salute San Raffaele University, Milan 2016–2019

VISITING

Visiting Fellow – NTU Singapore Summer 2026
Visiting Researcher – University of Pittsburgh Fall 2023
Visiting Research Student – King's College London Spring 2022
Visiting Graduate Student – University of Geneva Fall 2020

ACADEMIC PAPERS

9. 'Limiting Reduction and Modified Gravity', *British Journal for the Philosophy of Science* (forthcoming), with Antonis Antoniou
8. 'Making Sense of Gravitational Thermodynamics', *Philosophy of Physics* (2025)
7. 'Two Forms of Functional Reductionism in Physics', *Synthese* (2024)
6. 'Effective Ontic Structural Realism', *British Journal for the Philosophy of Science* (forthcoming), with James Ladyman
5. 'Functionalism, Reductionism, and Levels of Reality', *Philosophy of Science* (2023)
4. 'Functionalising the Wavefunction', *Studies in History and Philosophy of Science* (2022)

3. 'Structuralist Approaches to Bohmian Mechanics', *Synthese* (2022)
2. 'A Refined Propensity Account for GRW Theory', *Foundations of Physics* (2021)
1. 'Humean supervenience and tripartite entanglement relations', *Axiomathes* (2020)

BOOK REVIEWS

1. 'Scientific realism from the bottom-up', *Metascience* (2026). Review of Michel Ghins, *Scientific Realism and Laws of Nature: A Metaphysics of Causal Powers* (Springer, 2024).

EDITED COLLECTIONS

- 'The Aims and Methodologies of Contemporary Metaphysics' (2025), Synthese Topical Collection, lead guest editor (co-edited with Pyro Suarez and Tommaso Soriani)

POPULAR ARTICLES

- 'The Trouble With Limits: What frontier galactic physics can teach us about justifying new physics', *BJPS Short Read* (forth.) (based on 'Limiting Reduction and Modified Gravity')
- 'What do Newtonian Forces have to do with the Standard Model?' *BJPS Short Read* (2024) (based on 'Effective Ontic Structural Realism', including podcast version)

PRESENTATIONS

Peer-reviewed talks:

23. *A Relational General Relativistic A-theory*, AMAMI-SIFA mid-term conference, Ca' Foscari University, Venice, 1-3 September 2026 (joint work with Nicola Bamonti)
22. *Newton-Cartan Lessons for the Metaphysics of Time*, APSA Biennial Conference 2026, Singapore, 22-24 July 2026 (joint work with Enrico Cinti and Marco Sanchioni)
21. *A Relational General Relativistic A-theory*, European Congress for Metaphysics, Munich, 9-11 July 2026 (joint work with Nicola Bamonti)
20. *A Relational General Relativistic A-theory*, SILFS 2026, Pavia, 29-2 July 2026 (joint work with Nicola Bamonti)
19. *An Effective Approach to Naturalistic Metaphysics*, 2nd Parma Workshop in Analytic and Scientific Metaphysics, Parma, 15-16 December 2025
18. *Making Sense of Gravitational Thermodynamics*, 10th biennial meeting of the European Philosophy of Science Association, Groningen, 27-30 August 2025
17. *Making Sense of Gravitational Thermodynamics*, Italian Society for Logic and the Philosophy of Science (SILFS) Postgraduate Conference, Turin, 11-13 June 2025
16. *The Justification Gap Problem for Theory Reduction*, PSA's 29th biennial meeting, New Orleans, 14-17 November 2024
15. *Making Sense of Gravitational Thermodynamics*, 2nd History and Philosophy of Cosmology Conference, Milan, 10-13 September 2024

14. *Metaphysical Naturalism and Reduction in Biochemistry* (joint work with Francesca Bellazzi), part of 'Metaphysical Naturalism 2.0' symposium, The British Society for the Philosophy of Science annual conference, York, 17-19 July 2024
13. *Two forms of functional reductionism in physics*, The British Society for the Philosophy of Science annual conference, Bristol, 5-7 July 2023
12. *Two forms of functional reductionism in physics*, 21st European Conference on Foundations of Physics, Bristol, 8-10 July 2023
11. *Nagelian Reduction as Functional Reduction*, 7th Panhellenic Conference on Philosophy of Science, Athens, 1-3 December 2022
10. *How functional reduction bolsters reductive explanations*, The Society for the Metaphysics of Science 7th Annual Conference, Bristol, 7-9 September 2022
9. *Functionalism, Reductionism, and Levels of Reality*, 5th SILFS Postgraduate Conference on Logic and Philosophy of Science, Milan, June 13–17 2022
8. *Wave Function Realism vis-à-vis Functional Reduction*, 8th biennial meeting of the European Philosophy of Science Association (EPSA 21), Turin, September 2021
7. *Wave Function Realism vis-à-vis Functional Reduction*, Sixth Annual Conference of the Society for the Metaphysics of Science, September 1-4 2021
6. *Wave Function Realism vis-à-vis Functional Reduction*, British Society for the Philosophy of Science annual conference (BSPS 21), July 2021
5. *Putting Coherentism to Work: Redefining the Nature of the Wave Function*, Australasian Postgraduate Philosophy Conference, September 19-20, 2020
4. *Is there room for entanglement relations in the Humean mosaic?*, 10th European Conference for Analytic Philosophy (ECAP 10), online, August 24-28, 2020
3. *GRW, dispositions and objective probabilities*, Annual conference of the British Society for the Philosophy of Science, July 2020, canceled due to the pandemic
2. *Is there room for entanglement relations in the Humean mosaic?*, Annual conference of the German physical society, Bonn, April 2020, canceled due to the pandemic
1. *Dispositionalism and the laws of nature*, Lugano Undergraduate Conference in Philosophy, USI, February 2019

Invited and contributed talks:

16. *Perspectival Realism and Tense in General Relativity*, Spacetime in Pieces workshop, Ca' Foscari University, Venice, 9-10 September 2026 (joint work with Nicola Bamonti)
15. *Making Sense of Gravitational Thermodynamics*, Gravitational thermodynamics and beyond workshop, Dublin Institute for Advanced Studies, 10-12 June 2026
14. *Newtonian Lessons for the Metaphysics of Time*, Geneva Symmetry Group spring seminar, Geneva, 5 March 2026 (based on joint work with Enrico Cinti and Marco Sanchioni)
13. *Limiting Reduction and Modified Gravity*, Modeling the Cosmos: Frontiers in Philosophy of Astrophysics and Cosmology, Milan, 3-4 March 2026 (joint work with Antonis Antoniou)
12. *Saving Functionalism from Inconsistency*, Functionalism workshop, University of Oslo, 26-27 November 2025 (joint work with Joshua Babic)

11. *Newton-Cartan Lessons for the Metaphysics of Time*, Metaphysics of Cosmology workshop, Lugano, 10-12 September 2025 (based on joint work with Enrico Cinti and Marco Sanchioni)
10. *Quantum Physics and Effective Realism*, Workshop on Metaphysical and Epistemological Perspectives on Quantum Theory, Lugano, 28 June 2025 (joint work with James Ladyman)
9. *Limiting Reduction and Modified Gravity*, The Epistemology of Dark Matter and Modified Gravity workshop, Athens, 19-20 June 2025 (joint work with Antonis Antoniou)
8. *Limiting Reduction and Modified Gravity*, Harvard University's Black Hole Initiative foundations seminars, 14 April 2025 (joint work with Antonis Antoniou)
7. *Saving Functionalism from Inconsistency*, Theoretical Equivalence and Related Topics workshop, USI, Lugano, 8 April 2025 (joint work with Joshua Babic)
6. *Separatism and Unitism about Spacetime*, Geneva Symmetry Group research seminar series, University of Geneva, 13 March 2025 (joint work with Damiano Costa)
5. *Separatism and Unitism about Spacetime*, 4th Ca' Foscari-Lugano Workshop in Analytic Metaphysics, Venice, 16 December 2024 (joint work with Damiano Costa)
4. *Is Functionalism Trivial in Science?*, (Spacetime) Functionalism Workshop, King's College London, 16 June 2023
3. *Two forms of functional reductionism in physics*, Beyond Spacetime speaker series, University of Geneva, March 8 2023
2. *Two forms of functional reductionism in physics*, Philosophy of Physics graduate seminar, Oxford, February 14 2023
1. *Wave Function Realism vis-à-vis Functional Reduction*, Geneva Symmetry Group spring seminars, University of Geneva, March 2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor

- *Logic II* (formal logic), BA in Philosophy, Università della Svizzera italiana (USI), Lugano, Spring 2027 (co-taught with Joshua Babic)
- *Research Seminar* (academic writing skills), 24 hours, MA in Philosophy, Università della Svizzera italiana (USI), Lugano, Fall 2026 (co-taught with Paolo Natali)
- *The Metaphysics of Scientific Laws*, 9 hours, Catholic University of Milan, April 2026
- *Research Seminar* (academic writing skills), 24 hours, MA in Philosophy, Università della Svizzera italiana (USI), Lugano, Fall 2025 (co-taught with Paolo Natali)

Teaching Assistant

- *Philosophy of Science and Technology*, 9 hours, Polytechnic University of Milan, Fall 2026
- *Knowledge and Reality*, 22 hours, University of Bristol, Spring 2023
- *Logic and Critical Thinking*, 22 hours, University of Bristol, Fall 2022

Supervision

- Stefano di Blasio, Philosophy MA, Università della Svizzera italiana (USI), 2026–2027
- Jacopo Lanzi, Philosophy MA, Università della Svizzera italiana (USI), 2025–2027

SCHOLARSHIPS AND GRANTS

Major Grants and Scholarships

Swiss National Science Foundation, Ambizione grant 2025 — 2027–2031
"Effective Realism: A New Framework for the Ontology of the Sciences"
USI, Lugano — CHF 584.600

Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions (MSCA) Postdoctoral Fellowships 2025 — 2027–2029
"Effective Realism: A New Framework for the Ontology of the Sciences"
Polytechnic University of Milan — €193.643 *(declined)*

Arts and Humanities Research Council (SWW DTP), UK — 2021–2025
Doctoral scholarship
University of Bristol — Full PhD tuition fees & stipend

Other Grants, Awards, and Scholarships

Swiss National Science Foundation, Scientific Exchange grant — 2025
"The Metaphysics of Cosmology" workshop, USI Lugano — CHF 12.500

Royal Institute of Philosophy, Graduate Conference Funding — 2024
Funding to organise the 3rd BBLOC graduate workshop, Bristol — £600

Researcher-Led Initiatives Fund (SWW DTP) — 2024
"The Aims of Metaphysics" conference, Bristol — £2.362

Royal Institute of Philosophy, Graduate Conference Funding — 2023
Funding to organise the 2nd BBLOC graduate workshop, KCL — £600

Research Training Support Grant (SWW DTP) — 2023
Travel expenses for research visit at University of Pittsburgh — £4.410

Swiss cantonal merit-based scholarship for Italian citizens — 2019–2021
USI Lugano, Tuition fees plus living costs — CHF 26.000

Scholarship for the highest GPA in the Master in Philosophy Lugano — 2020
USI Lugano, Award — CHF 4.000

ACADEMIC SERVICES

Reviewer (I regularly serve as a reviewer for the following journals)

- *British Journal for the Philosophy of Science*
- *Philosophy of Science*
- *Australasian Journal of Philosophy*
- *Philosophical Quarterly*
- *European Journal for the Philosophy of Science*
- *Synthese*
- *Studies in History and Philosophy of Science*
- *Journal for General Philosophy of Science*
- *Foundations of Physics*

Conference organisation

- "Perspectives on the Foundations of Information Theory and Statistical Mechanics" workshop, USI, Lugano, 7–9 May 2026
- "The Metaphysics of Cosmology" workshop, USI, Lugano, 10-12 September 2025
- "The Aims of Metaphysics" conference, University of Bristol, 22-23 November 2024
- BBLOC 2nd Graduate conference in philosophy of physics, King's College London, 14 December 2023
- BBLOC 1st Graduate conference in philosophy of physics, King's College London, 14 December 2022

Scientific committees

- 3rd History & Philosophy of Cosmology Conference, Athens, July 2026
- 11th annual conference, Society for the Metaphysics of Science, Toronto, May 2026

Editor

- PhilPapers editor for the categories Interlevel Relations in Physical Science and Functionalism in Science (and related subcategories).

OUTREACH

- Spring 2026: Three lectures to high school students in Switzerland on scientific realism (Liceo cantonale di Bellinzona; Liceo cantonale di Lugano 3; Facoltà di Teologia di Lugano).
- April 2026: Organised a three-lecture introductory series on the philosophy of thermodynamics for philosophy students (USI, Lugano).
- March 2025: Interview on the relationship between free will, physics, and philosophy on the Italian-speaking Swiss state radio (RSI).
- March 2025: Public lecture in Lugano on what physics tells us about free will.
- Spring 2025: Two lectures to high school students in Switzerland on free will (Liceo cantonale Lugano 2; Liceo cantonale di Locarno).

AFFILIATIONS

Membership of research groups:

- Geneva Symmetry Group *(affiliate member)*

Societies:

- British Society for the Philosophy of Science (BSPS); Philosophy of Science Association (PSA); Philosophy of Physics Society; European Philosophy of Science Association (EPSA); Society for the Metaphysics of Science (SMS); Asian Philosophy of Science Association (APSA); Società Italiana di Logica e Filosofia delle Scienze (SILFS); History and Philosophy of Cosmology Society

REFERENCES

References available upon request.

Last updated 09/2026